TOPIC 5 · COPILOT AGENTS AND MINI CAPSTONE
LAB 12 THEME · MINI CAPSTONE

Lab 12 — Mini Capstone: Group Dashboard and Decision Deck

Maps to	LO5: build a grounded Copilot agent and apply the full workflow in a group capstone
Duration	45 minutes
Tools	Excel Copilot · PowerPoint Copilot · Microsoft 365 Copilot web
Mock data	Your own mock or sanitised dataset
Course	GenAI for Engineers · v2.4
Prompts	https://tertiarycourses.github.io/IES-GenAI-for-Engineers/prompts/#lab-12

Goal

In groups, build a dashboard and a 5-slide decision deck from your own fictional dataset, then present it in three minutes.

What You Will Build

Per group: a dataset, a .Rules sheet, an interactive dashboard, a 5-slide deck and a three-minute showcase.

Prerequisites

- Microsoft 365 account with Copilot available in Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook. Availability depends on the assigned licence and tenant settings; confirm access with the trainer before class.

Data note

Northstar Water Services is a fictional water-pipe maintenance and service company. All service hubs, staff and work orders are synthetic. Use the fixed reporting date 2026-09-30; missing facts remain UNKNOWN. Proposals do not change real assignments. Training email drafts are never sent.

Steps

Step 1. (5 min) Make a dataset. Form groups of 3-5. Go to https://copilot.cloud.microsoft, paste the prompt (change the domain to your own) and send it.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
MICROSOFT 365 COPILOT WEB:
Create a fictional dataset for an engineering team in [your domain, for example lift
maintenance]. Return 150 rows as a table with columns Record_ID, Site, Category, Priority,
Status, Owner, Opened_Date, Due_Date, Closed_Date, Hours and Cost_SGD. Use 2026 dates and no
real people, companies or places.
```

Step 2. (3 min) Put it in Excel. Paste the table into a new workbook, press Ctrl+T and name the table tblData. Add a sheet named Control with your reporting date in B2. Save it as Group_Dashboard.xlsx.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Table : tblData
Control : reporting date in B2
File : Group_Dashboard.xlsx
```

Step 3. (4 min) Add rules. Open Copilot, choose Allow editing, send the prompt and select Done.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
EXCEL - ALLOW EDITING:
Add a visible sheet named exactly .Rules. In column A, one rule per cell, write rules for this workbook: keep tblData unchanged; use the reporting date in Control!B2; six KPI tiles in row 4; charts below; slicers on the right; navy, blue and teal colours; chart titles that state a finding.
```

Step 4. (10 min) Build the dashboard. Install the interactive-dashboard skill from this lab's data/templates folder: in Copilot select Settings (...) > Manage plugins & skills > Custom skills > Add in OneDrive, upload the folder, then Refresh and turn it on. Send the prompt and select Done.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
EXCEL - ALLOW EDITING:
@interactive-dashboard Build a one-page dashboard for tblData that follows the .Rules: six KPI tiles, three charts and slicers that filter every tile and chart.
```

Step 5. (7 min) Make the deck. Open data/templates/Northstar_Management_Deck_Template.pptx (or your own template) in PowerPoint. Open Copilot, paste the prompt, type your dashboard numbers after it and send it.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
POWERPOINT COPILOT:
Using the dashboard numbers below, create a five-slide decision deck: 1 scope and date, 2-3 one finding per slide, 4 proposed actions, 5 the decision needed. No invented causes or savings.
```

Step 6. (12 min) Present. Each group has three minutes: the question, the dashboard (click one slicer), the decision slide and one thing Copilot got wrong that you caught.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Time : 3 minutes per group
```

Copy buttons for every prompt: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/IES-GenAI-for-Engineers/prompts/#lab-12

Test It

Check	Expected result
Safe data	Fictional data only.
Dashboard	Tiles and charts follow the slicers.
Deck	Numbers match the dashboard; actions labelled proposed.
Showcase	Three minutes, one live slicer click.

If You Get Stuck

Short of time? Present the Lab 8 Northstar dashboard and your Lab 10 deck instead, and say so in the showcase.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
Copilot cannot see my file	In Excel, save the file and open Copilot again. In Word, PowerPoint or Outlook, upload the file with + > Upload images and files, and upload it again after you change it.
A number is different from the lab	Clear any slicers or filters, check the table has no extra rows, then ask again in a new chat.
A button or feature is missing	Check you are signed in with your course account and Microsoft 365 is up to date, then tell your trainer.

Challenge

Turn your group’s .Rules and dashboard Skill into a reusable pair your team can apply to next month’s data.

Reflection

Which evidence proves the output is correct, and which decision still needs a person?